

Academic Writing & Assignment

Week 2: Lesson 4



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

Annotated Bibliographies



- An annotated bibliography is a list of cited sources (books, articles, reports etc.) that are followed by a brief summary of its contents.
- This week your task is to submit an annotated bibliography for **THREE** of the texts you will use for your assignment.



Steps to creating an annotated bibliography:



1. Locate possible sources which you think will be relevant for your essay
2. Briefly examine and review your chosen sources, deciding which are most relevant for your topic
3. Cite your chosen resource using the correct referencing style

Steps to creating an annotated bibliography:



Write an annotation which summarises the main idea or scope of your chosen source. This annotation should be between 100 and 300 words. It should include:

- A description of the theoretical background of the author: how authoritative are they within their field?
- An indication of the intended audience
- A summary of the contents
- The main idea, argument or theme of the source
- An evaluation of its relevance, strengths, potential weaknesses and limitations, an indication of methodology (if relevant) etc.
- An indication of useful ideas or materials in the source that you may use in your work

- Annotated bibliographies should be formal in style and language used.
- Your style should be objective and factual, drawing on reporting verbs to indicate the author's argument.
- You can choose to write in full sentences or in clear bullet pointed lists, addressing the above criteria, whichever style you choose, be consistent!

Evaluating sources



- Academic sources take many forms and provide the evidence needed to validate your research. Using a wide range of credible sources will help to develop and support your argument.
- Those you locate in the Library Catalogue and most of those on Google Scholar will be reliable, however you will sometimes be required to critically evaluate them, their context, and the contribution they make.
- What do you think you should consider when critically evaluating a source?

Some dimensions you can consider are presented in the CRAAP framework:



C Currency

R Relevance

A Authority

A Accuracy

P Purpose



C: Currency relates to the date of the source



Some questions to ask yourself when determining the currency of a source:

- What is the date of the information?
- Has the information been updated?
- If the information isn't recent, does this matter i.e. is this information still relevant if it is an older source?

R: Relevance relates to a source's suitability for your research and audience



Some questions to ask yourself when determining the relevance of a source:

- Does the source help to develop your argument?
- What do other sources say? Is your current source still relevant?
- Are there other more relevant sources?

A: Authority relates to the source of the information



Some questions to ask yourself when determining the authority of a source:

- Who is the author/publisher/organisation producing the information?
- What are their credentials?
- Is it easy to find out more about the author/publisher/organisation?
- What qualifies them to produce information on this subject?

A: Accuracy relates to the trustworthiness of the source



Some questions to ask yourself when determining the accuracy of a source:

- Where does the information come from?
- Is the language error free? Is the tone balanced?
- What do other reliable sources say about your chosen source? You may want to read some reviews of your source to check this.
- What references does your source use? Are these correct and reliable? Sources with no references or with incorrect or skewed information may not be accurate.

P: Purpose relates to the point of the research



Some questions to ask yourself when determining the purpose of a source:

- Why was the research disseminated e.g. to inform, sell, persuade, guide, entertain? Is its purpose clear?
- Does the purpose of the research fit your own research agenda?
- Is the information impartial?
- Is the information factual or opinion?

Example One



Manovich, Lev. (2009). The practice of everyday (media) life: From mass consumption to mass cultural production? *Critical Inquiry*, 35(2), 319–331. <https://www.jstor.org/stable/0.1086/596645>

Manovich's article assesses the shift from a consumption-based media culture (in which media content is produced by a small number of professionals and consumed by a mass audience) to a production-based media culture (in which this mass audience is just as active in producing content as in consuming it). He is sceptical of some of the claims made about this cultural shift; specifically, he argues that the shift towards user-made content must be regarded as more reliant upon commercial media production than it is typically acknowledged to be. However, he regards web 2.0 as an exciting ongoing development for art and media production, citing its innovation and unpredictability.

The article is outdated in certain ways (it dates from 2009, before the launch of Instagram, to give just one example). Nevertheless, its critical engagement with the possibilities opened up for media production by the growth of social media is valuable in a general sense, and its conceptualization of these changes frequently applies just as well to more current social media platforms as it does to Myspace. Conceptually, I intend to draw on this article in my own analysis of the social dynamics of Twitter and Instagram.

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The first sentence describes the topic of the article

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These sentences go into more detail about the author's arguments

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These sentences assess the usefulness of the article assessing its strengths and weaknesses.

Example Two



Impact of the COVID-19 Pandemic on Online Consumer Purchasing Behaviour

With the spread of the COVID-19 pandemic and the increasing importance of e-commerce, the study of online consumer behaviour is of particular relevance. The purpose of this study was to form a methodological approach to assess the relationships and the level of influence of the factors activating the purchasing behaviour of online consumers against the background of the COVID-19 pandemic. The research methodology was based on the transformation of Cattell's questionnaire and the implementation of correlation analysis. To determine the predisposition of online consumer behaviour at the time of making a purchase decision, this study used the questionnaire method. The survey was conducted among online shoppers in the top 10 countries in terms of e-commerce market growth. The scientific contribution is the proposed methodological toolkit to assess the purchasing behaviour of online consumers, which identifies the most influential factors in their purchasing behaviour and provides an opportunity to assess the dynamics of their activity during the study period, to identify key trends and determine changes in their behaviour. The research revealed what changes in online consumer buying behaviour are typical in the COVID-19 pandemic. The impact of consumer awareness and experience has increased. Online consumers have become more experienced, which has influenced the activity of their buying behaviour. This study proved the shifting influence of online consumer purchasing behaviour factors during the pandemic. The increasing importance of the speed of decision making by consumers when purchasing goods and services online was determined.

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This annotated bibliography is largely descriptive.

Only the highlighted sentence comments on the quality of the article.

Example Three



Priceless data: why the EU fundamental right to data protection is at odds with trade in personal data Bart Custers, Gianclaudio Malgieri

The authors of the essay are Bart Custers & Gianclaudio Malgieri are established scholars in the field of data protection, privacy, and law , who are known for their research on the legal and ethical aspects of information technology, data protection, and artificial intelligence. The article explores the tension between the fundamental right to data protection, as guaranteed by EU data protection law, and the commercial models, which disqualifies personal data as a commodity. The main idea of the article is to analyze and discuss how users would retain their inalienable data subject rights to stop or restrict the data processing, as the GDPR does not allow mandating data. What is worth mentioning is that it also reflects if people invoke their data subject rights on the legal basis of consent at any time, considerable legal uncertainty may be triggered in transactions, particularly on the side of data controllers, potentially undermining EU's envisioned data economy. This source is likely to be relevant for scholars, researchers, policymakers, data giants and legal practitioners interested in the intersection of data protection rights and the trade in personal data within the European Union context. Through understanding legal mechanisms employed by the EU to protect personal data, as well as the challenges posed by the commercial trade in personal data, I can further learn from innovative solutions proposed by the authors and discussions on potential reforms, regulatory gaps.

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This annotated bibliography contains a good mix of summary and comment / evaluation.

Example Three



Cultural capital: Bourdieu, P. (2011). The forms of capital.(1986). Cultural theory: An anthology, 1, 81-93.

Bourdieu regards people's lives as a combination of various fields and uses capital as a tool for the analysis of human society. He proposes that capital, which is exclusive, is the materialisation of labour and the result of historical accumulation. Cultural capital is premised on internalisation, and the family is an important field for the transformation of economic capital into cultural capital. Cultural capital is continuously reproduced through the intergenerational transmission of parenting and investment in education.

Bourdieu's theory demonstrates that social structures and cultures are self-replicating processes and that capital perpetuates privilege and inequality with class habitus. The theoretical perspective is unique and clearly illustrates that people carry out social activities in the field, while competing for and appropriating capital. There are also some problems with the theory. Bourdieu overemphasises the stable side of society and fails to realise that society is fluid. For example, Pareto's theory of elite circulation explains that upper and lower classes are open to interchangeable status. Bourdieu ignores the dynamic nature of people and does not accept that people in lower classes can work their way up to higher classes.

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This annotated bibliography also contains a good balance between summary and comment / evaluation.

Task



- Find 3 sources for your assignment
- Choose a referencing style and write a reference for the sources

